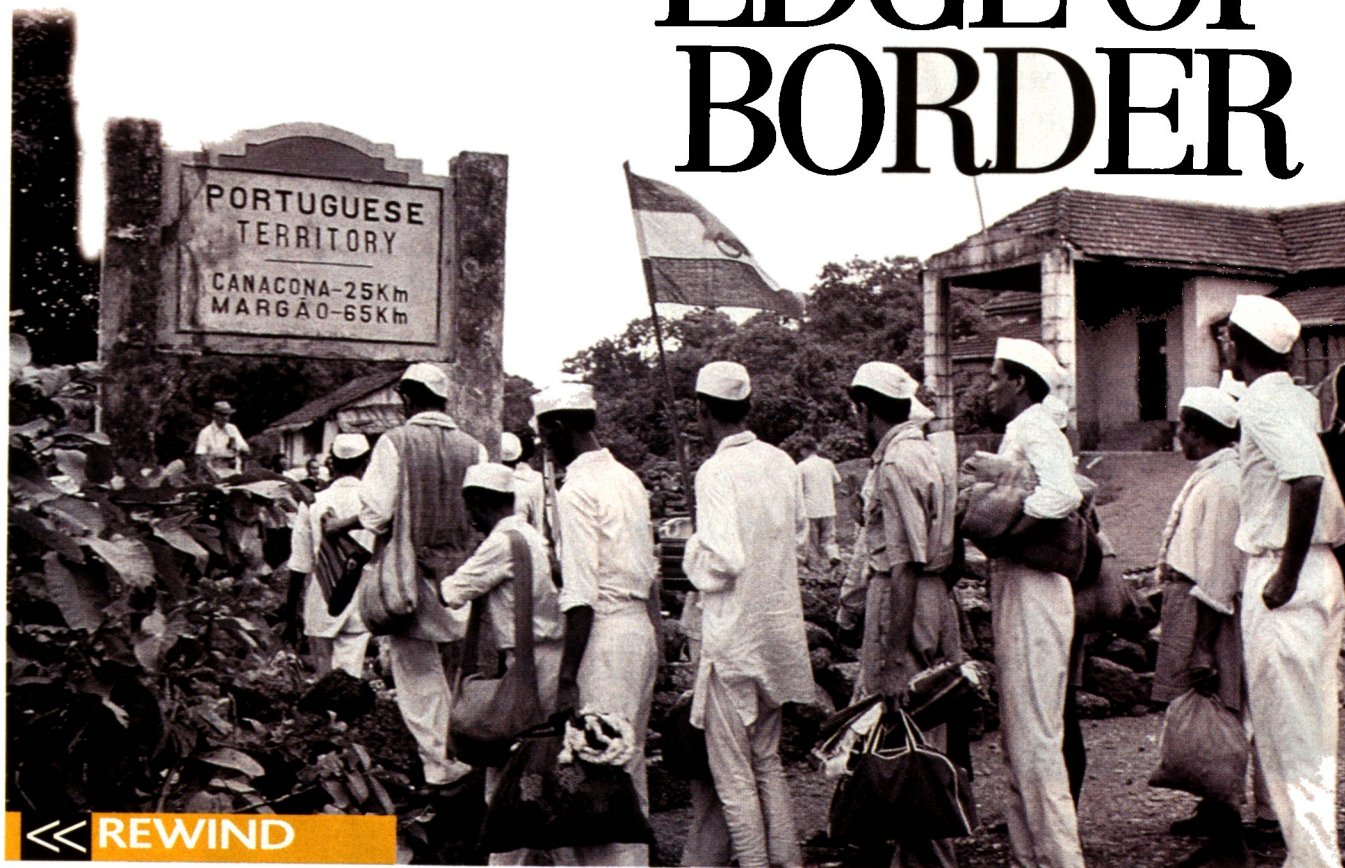


Photo: Reuters/Burke Trovati/Photo Agency, India

FIGHT FOR FREEDOM:
Satyagrahis march
towards the Indian
border in Goa in 1954

EDGE OF BORDER



<< REWIND

Nehru's foreign policy was opposed to the continuance of colonial rule anywhere. This meant reclaiming parts of the country still languishing under foreign yoke. Things came to a head when unarmed satyagrahis were fired upon by Portuguese authorities in Goa, which dictator Antonio de Oliveira Salazar had described as "a light of the West in lands of the Orient". An enraged India asked the Portugal government to close their legation in Delhi and its consulates in other cities. The Indian consulate-general in Goa was withdrawn on September 1.

CODE-BREAKER

Despite differences between the prime minister and president, the Hindu law was modernised with a series of acts reforming laws on marriage, succession, guardianship and adoption, passed over two years.

FIRST CUT

- HEC-2M, the first computer in the country, was installed in Calcutta.
- Bharat Petroleum became the first company to market liquid petroleum gas for home use.

- General Maharaj Rajendra Sinhji became the first person to hold the rank of Chief of Army Staff.
- State Bank of India, formed in July, became the first Indian bank to be nationalised.

<< DID YOU KNOW

The crowd that turned up to hear Jawaharlal Nehru speak at Moscow's Gorky Park was so large that the venue had to be shifted to the Dynamo Moscow Football Stadium.